

Negotiate Your Lease

Understand the full commitment before you sign.

MISSION BRIEF

Compare term, rent, deposits, operating costs, improvements, signage, use restrictions, maintenance, renewal, assignment, and exit provisions.

FOUR OPERATING PRINCIPLES

Price the entire obligation Base rent may not include common-area charges, utilities, taxes, insurance, repairs, security, parking, or required improvements.	Confirm permitted use The agreement should support tax preparation, appointments, staffing, signage, hours, privacy modifications, and the intended technology.
Allocate responsibilities Clarify maintenance, repairs, build-out, accessibility, compliance, damage, restoration, and insurance responsibilities.	Plan the exit Review term, renewal, increases, assignment, sublease, default, personal guarantees, early termination, and restoration obligations with counsel.

TOOLKIT SOURCE: PAGES 42-45

Verify current requirements with official sources and qualified professionals.

Prepare your lease review

Capture business terms and legal questions for qualified review. This lesson does not replace legal advice.

Term and renewal

Start, end, options, notice, and increases

Total occupancy cost

Rent, common charges, utilities, taxes, insurance, parking

Permitted use and hours

Tax preparation, staffing, appointments, events, access

Improvements and maintenance

Build-out, repairs, accessibility, restoration

Signage and visibility

Exterior, window, monument, and directory rights

Exit and risk terms

Guarantee, default, assignment, sublease, termination

Lease clauses for legal, insurance, or financial review

Use this page to prepare focused questions for the appropriate government agency, attorney, tax professional, banker, insurer, landlord, technology professional, or vendor.

1. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

2. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

3. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

4. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

READY CHECK	STATUS
Source requirements verified	[]
Action-plan facts documented	[]
Professional questions prepared	[]
Source documents stored securely	[]
Next owner and due date assigned	[]

Do not place Social Security numbers, client return information, account credentials, or other sensitive identifiers in this worksheet.